GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

April 24th, 2026
Week 17
Volume 282, Issue 1232

Highlights:

- **Truce indefinite.**
- **Hormuz escalates.**
- **Freight climbs.**
- **Owners wait.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Uncertainty is the only certainty there is, and knowing how to live with insecurity is the only security"

-John Allen Paulos

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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INDEFINITE, NOT RESOLVED

The Week 16 view that a temporary memorandum had narrowed the diplomatic off-ramp has already been overtaken. On April 22, President Trump extended the US-Iran ceasefire indefinitely after Pakistan-hosted talks failed to convene. Within hours, Iran attacked three commercial vessels in the Strait of Hormuz and claimed seizure of two, following a US Navy interdiction of an Iranian-flagged cargo vessel earlier in the week. The US naval blockade of Iranian ports remains fully in force, while the Pentagon now estimates mine clearance in Hormuz will take approximately six months. More than thirty countries are assembling a multinational task force at an RAF base outside London, though deployment remains contingent on a durable ceasefire. The extension is indefinite. The resolution is not.

Energy markets have responded accordingly. Brent rallied about 5 percent to USD 94.90 per barrel on April 20 on seizure headlines, with WTI at USD 88.44. The prior week's slide on IEA demand concerns has reversed as geopolitical risk reasserts itself, and the recent inventory draw now reflects tightening supply rather than weakening demand.

Freight continues to diverge. The Baltic Dry Index closed at 2,673 on April 23, up about 150 points from 2,523 a week earlier, extending a twelve-session rally before easing marginally. Capesize earnings are at a four-month high on sustained Brazil to China iron ore flows, with Panamax and Supramax also firmer. The expected Q1 tonnage release has now been deferred for a third consecutive week as owners continue to favour trading over recycling.

Currencies reflect re-embedded risk. USD to INR has weakened to 93.80 after partial RBI unwinding, approaching the March 27 low of 94.86. USD to BDT remains rangebound at 122.70 to 123.00, USD to PKR has edged to 279.70, and the Turkish lira has hit a fresh low near 44.92. The Dollar Index has softened to about 98.2. This does not alter sub-continent pricing dynamics. It reinforces them.

With five weeks remaining before the monsoon window closes, Bangladesh's LC pipeline is clearing, Pakistan's Gulf proximity advantage is strengthening, and India retains its HKC compliance edge. Aliaga remains structurally uncompetitive outside EU tonnage. Across all destinations, the constraint remains unchanged. Owners are not releasing tonnage, and the indefinite ceasefire offers no incentive to do so.

The Week 16 question of whether supply returns before the monsoon or rolls into backlog has been provisionally answered in favour of backlog. Week 17 closes with the ceasefire indefinite, the blockade intact, mines six months from clearance, and the beaching window narrowing by the day.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 17 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

PIPELINE CLEARS, WINDOW TIGHTENS

LC flow accelerates.

Bangladesh enters Week 17 with its Letter of Credit pipeline clearing at its fastest pace since the post-Eid reopening. The central bank approvals that defined Q1 friction have now moved meaningfully faster over the past ten days, and Chattogram cash buyers report turnaround on qualified files materially shorter than the February benchmark. Bangladesh Bank is holding its policy rate at 10%, with foreign exchange reserves reported at USD 34.12 billion as of March, and the macro stability is sufficient to sustain the current transaction environment without fresh constraints. The USD/BDT rate has held in its 122.70 to 123.00 band through the week, preserving the direct flow-through of local steel strength into USD offer capacity that continues to distinguish Chattogram from Alang and Aliaga.

Steel steadies.

Local steel plate prices are holding in the BDT 69,400 to 71,000 per ton band, translating to a USD equivalent of approximately USD 571 to USD 584 per ton. The modest softening at the Week 16 close has not extended, and the plate market appears to be absorbing the firmer freight complex without passing it through to offer levels. Chattogram's position as the sub-continent's highest bidder remains unchallenged on dry bulk and tanker tonnage across the LDT spectrum. The compliance shadow cast by the two OFAC-sanctioned VLCCs at OPL Chattogram persists into its sixth week, and the heightened due diligence culture across the cash buyer community is now effectively embedded as an operating practice rather than an episodic response.

Monsoon nears.

Bangladesh's March 2026 CPI print at 8.71%, down from 9.13% in February, with non-food inflation holding at 9.09%, continues to provide the central bank the flexibility it needs on LC approvals without introducing fresh macro noise. The monsoon window has tightened to approximately five weeks. The fresh escalation in the Gulf has reinforced owners' inclination to keep tonnage trading rather than beach it, and the Week 16 expectation of supply release has now fully given way to the Week 17 expectation of Q1 overhang rolling into a Q2 backlog. Bangladesh has the financial positioning, the compliance pathway, the pricing, and the urgency. It does not have the ships. The problem is unchanged and worsening.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

RUPEE DRIFTS, ALANG HOLDS

Currency tells.

India's Week 17 opens with USD/INR oscillating between 93.30 and 93.80, extending the drift that began at the close of Week 15. The Reserve Bank of India partially unwound its recent foreign-exchange restrictions during the week, a move that has supported trading flexibility but also reintroduced two-way volatility into onshore-offshore arbitrage flows. The March 27 record low of 94.86 remains within a stress-event reach. The central bank's intervention capacity is not exhausted, but its appetite to deploy further reserves into a market whose underlying driver remains the unresolved Hormuz situation has visibly contracted. The currency continues to tell a cleaner story than the oil market.

Hormuz reseals.

The US naval blockade of Iranian ports continues in full force, and Iran's seizure and attack on three commercial vessels in the Strait on April 22 has effectively reset the transit risk posture for India's energy import flows. Approximately 90% of India's LPG continues to route through Hormuz-exposed corridors, and approximately 70% of crude is similarly dependent. The Pentagon's formal six-month estimate for clearing Iranian-laid mines, even in the best-case ceasefire scenario, has materially shifted the base case for a durable strait reopening from weeks to quarters. Whatever directional benefit the Week 15 oil softening was supposed to deliver to India's import bill has been unwound by the Week 17 escalation, and then some.

Supply stalls.

Local steel plate prices at Alang have oscillated between INR 40,700 and INR 41,500 through the week, with the USD equivalent at approximately USD 435 to USD 444 per ton, keeping India as the lowest-priced sub-continent destination. The gap to Pakistan holds near USD 200 per LDT. India's CPI for March 2026 at 3.40%, released April 13 and marking the highest reading in over a year, remains comfortably within the RBI's 2%-6% tolerance band that has now been formally reaffirmed for the 2026 to 2031 period. Alang's structural differentiators - more than 110 HKC-compliant yards, a durable regulatory framework, deep yard capacity for regulated European and Japanese tonnage - remain fully intact. The constraint is the same constraint that the whole sub-continent is facing. The tonnage is not arriving. The monsoon is.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

PROXIMITY PREMIUM RESTORED

Stability compounds.

Pakistan's Week 17 extends the stability theme that defined Weeks 15 and 16 and is now actively compounding it. USD/PKR has edged marginally to approximately 279.70 from 278.90 at the Week 16 close, a move that is material only on a multi-week view and which the broader cash buyer community has registered as noise rather than signal. Local steel plate prices at PKR 188,000 per ton are unchanged, translating to a USD equivalent near USD 672 per ton and keeping Gadani at the firmest absolute USD pricing position of the year. The gap to India has widened further to approximately USD 228 to USD 237 per LDT. The March 2026 CPI print at 7.3%, up from 7% in February and the highest reading since August 2024, sits above the State Bank's 5% to 7% target band, but the composition - transport and housing driving the move, food decelerating - keeps yard-level economics manageable given the stable PKR base.

Gulf premium returns.

The Week 16 speculation that a broader de-escalation might moderate Pakistan's Gulf proximity advantage has been fully invalidated by the Week 17 escalation. The US naval blockade of Iranian ports, the Iranian vessel attacks in Hormuz on April 22, the failure of the proposed Pakistan-hosted US-Iran talks to convene, and the Pentagon's six-month mine-clearance estimate are, in aggregate, a complete reversal of that speculative case. Gadani's proximity to the Gulf is not a marginal advantage in this environment. It is a compounding structural premium that is directing tonnage flow toward Pakistan and away from both Bangladesh and India on any candidate where Gulf transit economics matter. Three HKC-certified yards are now operational with further certifications in the pipeline. The pool of recycling candidates in the medium-sized dry bulk, LPG, and offshore segments continues to align well with Gadani's capacity, and all three structural reinforcements - compliance, pricing, logistics - are now operating simultaneously and with increased intensity.

Execution gate.

The one unresolved question for Pakistan remains whether this reinforced structural position translates into executed transactions before the monsoon window closes. The indefinite nature of the current ceasefire extension, absent any concrete proposal from Iran and with the US explicitly maintaining the blockade, makes the near-term durable resolution scenario less plausible than it was a week ago. Pakistan enters the second half of Q2's pre-monsoon window on the firmest footing of the year, and the window to consolidate that position into executed tonnage is now five weeks and shrinking. Pakistan has the most to gain if the current geopolitical configuration holds through the monsoon. It has the most to lose if a durable resolution arrives in the next three weeks. On current evidence, the former is significantly more likely than the latter.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

HOLDING, NOT HEALING

Lira breaks.

Turkey enters Week 17 with the lira at a fresh record low near 44.92 per USD, extending the controlled and slow devaluation that the Central Bank of Turkey has been managing through active intervention in foreign exchange markets. The TCMB held its key policy rate unchanged for the second consecutive decision in April, confirming the pivot away from the earlier rate-cutting cycle that the war in the Middle East forced the bank to abandon. The TCMB sold more than USD 8 billion in foreign exchange in the first week of March to defend the currency, and the halt on reverse repo auctions has driven the lira's overnight reference rate near 40% as the bank tightens liquidity conditions to support the currency.

Disinflation narrows.

March 2026 CPI at 30.87%, down from 31.53% in February and below the market expectation of 31.4 %, marks the third consecutive month of slower annual inflation, but the monthly print of 1.94 %, while the lowest in three months, reflects transport inflation accelerating to 34.35% annually as fuel costs from the Gulf situation continue to pass through. Independent estimates remain materially above the official read, with ENAG at 54.62% and Istanbul Chamber data at 37.68%. The central bank's 16% year-end target remains formally in place but is increasingly difficult to reconcile with either trajectory. The disinflation narrative is narrow. The reconciliation is not arriving.

Niche persists.

At USD 265 to USD 288 per LDT across vessel types, Aliaga remains structurally uncompetitive for mainstream tonnage. The gap to Pakistan at approximately USD 445 to USD 480 and to Bangladesh at USD 460 to USD 495 has widened further with the lira's fresh weakness, and the bridge to those levels is unavailable, absent EU-regulated tonnage where Basel Convention compliance overrides price. Turkey's relevance this Q2 is confined to that niche. The fresh escalation in the Gulf does not change this. Nothing in Week 17 does.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 17 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	460-465 / LDT	480-485 / LDT	490-495 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Firming**	445-450 / LDT	465-470 / LDT	475-480 / LDT
3	India	**Softening**	425-430 / LDT	445-450 / LDT	455-460 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Softening**	265-268 / LDT	275-278 / LDT	285-288 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *By recycling ships at Alang instead of producing steel from iron ore, approximately 124.5 million barrels of oil have been saved.*

- *The emissions avoided through ship recycling at Alang are equivalent to driving approximately 180 billion kilometers by passenger cars.*

- *More than 70.68 million tons (LDT) of ship material have been processed at Alang, representing one of the largest concentrated material recovery efforts globally.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
May 01 – Buddha Purnima	April 29 – May 06 May 16 – May 22

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
May 01 – Labour Day	April 30 May 01 – May 03

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
May 01 – Labour Day	May 01 – Labour Day May 19 - Commemoration of Atatürk & Youth Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of April 24, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
	No new vessels reported.			
Morality		-		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of April 24, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Shin Ho Chun No. 102	2,113	Refrigerate Cargo Ship	*Delivered April 23*
2	Ocean Rosemary	8,783	Bulk Carrier	Arrived April 23
3	Jiang	21,238	Bulk Carrier	Arrived April 21

GADANI - Port Position as of April 24, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
	No new vessels reported.			
Total Tonnage		-		

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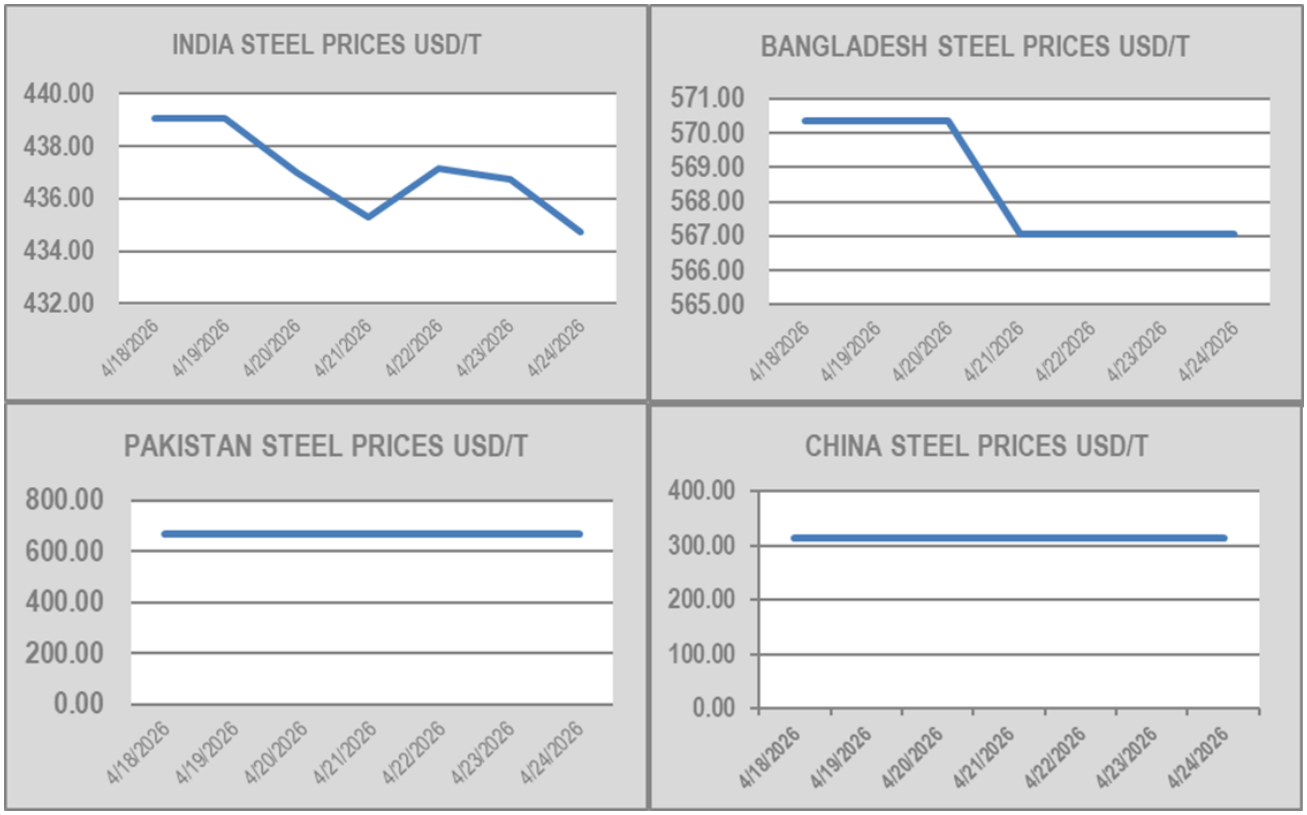
Steel Plate Prices

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
4/18/2026	439.09	40,800.00	671.43	188,000.00	570.37	69,300.00	313.77
4/19/2026	439.09	40,800.00	671.43	188,000.00	570.37	69,300.00	313.77
4/20/2026	437.02	40,700.00	671.43	188,000.00	570.37	69,300.00	313.77
4/21/2026	435.29	40,700.00	671.43	188,000.00	567.08	68,900.00	313.77
4/22/2026	437.15	41,000.00	671.43	188,000.00	567.08	68,900.00	313.77
4/23/2026	436.72	41,100.00	671.43	188,000.00	567.08	68,900.00	313.77
4/24/2026	434.74	41,000.00	671.43	188,000.00	567.08	68,900.00	313.77



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